

India's biggest electronics cluster project to take off at Bhosari, Pune

After receiving an in-principle approval in 2015, the much-awaited brownfield electronics manufacturing cluster being established by Maharashtra Chamber of Commerce, Industries and Agriculture (MCCIA) is set to take off within the next three months. Wg Cdr (Retd) Shalak Gandhi, managing director designate of MCCIA Electronics Cluster Foundation, told *Hindustan Times* that, work on the ₹ 670 million project has commenced and actual infrastructure

work at Bhosari will begin in the April to June 2018 quarter.

The project is part of Central government's electronics manufacturing clusters scheme of 2012, which aims to make India a global player in electronics and to create world-class infrastructure in electronics system and design manufacturing. The cluster in Pune aims to improve the infrastructure in the region, provide a common facility centre and give a boost to the local electronics ecosystem.

After duty cut, TV makers may switch to Make in India

Television makers LG, Samsung, Panasonic, BPL, TCL and Sanyo are reviving their Make in India plans after the government halved the customs duty on open cell panels to five per cent. These panels account for two-thirds of the cost of assembling LED sets. After a 10 per cent duty was imposed on open cell panels in the Budget earlier this year, leading companies and contract manufacturers shelved plans to assemble TVs locally. They contended that rather than assemble locally, it would be cheaper to import ready-to-use TV

panels from South Korea, China and other Southeast Asian countries.

Imports from these nations enjoy concessional duties because of the trade agreements India has signed with them. Open cell panels require final assembling to make LED TV panels. *Economic Times* reported that Consumer Electronics and Appliances Manufacturers Association (CEAMA) now expects investments of over ₹ 10 billion in the assembly of TV panels and in manufacturing, with several thousand jobs to be generated over the next one year.

Xiaomi sets up three manufacturing units in India

Chinese smartphone maker Xiaomi has set up three new smartphone manufacturing units in Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh. The new units will help the company produce more devices locally to meet the demand and consolidate its position in the extremely competitive Indian smart-

phone market.

According to Manu Jain, vice president and India managing director, Xiaomi, this move will double Xiaomi's manufacturing capacity in India to two phones per second during operational hours. These facilities employ over 10,000 people of which 95 per cent are women.

On The Move

Rishad Premji appointed chairman of NASSCOM

Rishad Premji, chief strategy officer and board member of Wipro Ltd, has been appointed chairman of IT industry body National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM) for 2018-19. He succeeds Raman Roy, chairman and managing director, Quatro Global Services, who served as chairman of NASSCOM for 2017-18.

Santanu Bhattacharya joins Airtel as chief data scientist

Bharti Airtel has appointed ex-NASA executive Santanu Bhattacharya as chief data scientist to accelerate efforts around emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence, the Internet of Things, augmented reality and virtual reality. He will oversee day-to-day operations of Airtel's upcoming digital innovation lab in Bengaluru, which will focus on these emerging technologies.

Continental appoints Alexander Klotz as India Technical Centre head

Alexander Klotz has been appointed as head of Continental India Technical Center. He brings with him more than 15 years of automotive industry experience, having held leadership positions focused on R&D and business functions. He was head of advanced development within systems and technology, division interior at Continental, and was instrumental in setting up the company's first location in Silicon Valley in 2013.

Xiaomi is also setting up a PCB assembly unit in Sriperumbudur in partnership with Foxconn. "We are committed to manufacturing in India. PCB is 50 per cent of the value of a phone. By Q3, all Xiaomi phones made in India will have PCBs that are locally assembled," Jain said.

This announcement comes after the Indian government levied 10 per cent import duty on some key smartphone components, including populated PCBs.